

2.5.25

Vaishnavi - EE25BTECH11059

September 8, 2025

Question

If $\mathbf{a} = 2\hat{i} - \hat{j} - 2\hat{k}$ and $\mathbf{b} = 7\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} - 3\hat{k}$, then express $\mathbf{b}$ in the form $\mathbf{b} = \mathbf{b}_1 + \mathbf{b}_2$, where $\mathbf{b}_1$ is parallel to $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}_2$ is perpendicular to $\mathbf{a}$.

Solution

Variable	Value
a	$2\hat{i} - \hat{j} - 2\hat{k}$
b	$7\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} - 3\hat{k}$

Table: Variables Used

Solution

$$\mathbf{a} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -1 \\ -2 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1)$$

$$\mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} 7 \\ 2 \\ -3 \end{pmatrix} \quad (2)$$

Let $\mathbf{b}_1 = k\mathbf{a}$ (where k is any scalar multiple)

$$\mathbf{b}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 2k \\ -k \\ -2k \end{pmatrix} \quad (3)$$

$$\mathbf{b} = \mathbf{b}_1 + \mathbf{b}_2 \quad (4)$$

taking scalar product with $\mathbf{a}$ on both sides

$$\mathbf{b}\mathbf{a}^T = \mathbf{b}_1\mathbf{a}^T + \mathbf{b}_2\mathbf{a}^T \quad (5)$$

Solution

As $\mathbf{b}_2 \mathbf{a}^T = 0$

And $\mathbf{b}_1 = k\mathbf{a}$

$$18 = 9k \quad (6)$$

$$k = 2 \quad (7)$$

$$\mathbf{b}_2 = \mathbf{b} - \mathbf{b}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 7 \\ 2 \\ -3 \end{pmatrix} - \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ -2 \\ -4 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 4 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (8)$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} 7 \\ 2 \\ -3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ -2 \\ -4 \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 4 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (9)$$

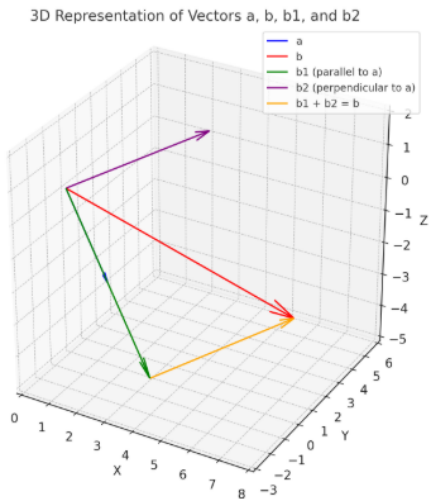
Therefore,

$$\mathbf{b}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ -2 \\ -4 \end{pmatrix} \quad (10)$$

$$\mathbf{b}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 4 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (11)$$

Graph

Refer to Figure



Python Code

```
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import numpy as np

# Define vectors
a = np.array([2, -1, -2])
b = np.array([7, 2, -3])
b1 = np.array([4, -2, -4])
b2 = np.array([3, 4, 1])

# Function to draw vectors
def draw_vector(ax, start, vec, color, label):
    ax.quiver(*start, *vec, color=color, label=label,
              arrow_length_ratio=0.1)

# Create 3D plot
fig = plt.figure(figsize=(10,8))
ax = fig.add_subplot(111, projection='3d')
```

Python Code

```
# Draw from origin
origin = np.array([0,0,0])
draw_vector(ax, origin, a, 'blue', 'a')
draw_vector(ax, origin, b, 'red', 'b')
draw_vector(ax, origin, b1, 'green', 'b1 (parallel to
a)')
draw_vector(ax, origin, b2, 'purple', 'b2 (
perpendicular to a)')

# Show b as b1 + b2 (parallelogram completion)
draw_vector(ax, b1, b2, 'orange', 'b1 + b2 = b')
```

Python Code

```
# Labels and title
ax.set_xlabel('X', fontsize=12)
ax.set_ylabel('Y', fontsize=12)
ax.set_zlabel('Z', fontsize=12)
ax.set_title( 3D Representation of Vectors a, b, b1,
              and b2 , fontsize=14)
ax.legend()

# Grid and aspect ratio
ax.grid(True)
ax.set_box_aspect([1,1,1])

# Axis limits
ax.set_xlim(0,8)
ax.set_ylim(-3,6)
ax.set_zlim(-5,2)

# Save figure
plt.savefig( Graph3.png , dpi=300, bbox_inches=tight)
```

C Code

```
#include <stdio.h>

int dotProduct(int a[], int b[], int size) {
    int dot = 0;
    for (int i = 0; i < size; i++) {
        dot += a[i] * b[i];
    }
    return dot;
}

void scalarMultiply(int vector[], int scalar, int
    result[], int size) {
    for (int i = 0; i < size; i++) {
        result[i] = scalar * vector[i];
    }
}
```

```
void vectorSubtract(int a[], int b[], int result[],
    int size) {
    for (int i = 0; i < size; i++) {
        result[i] = a[i] - b[i];
    }
}

void solve_vectors() {
    int a[3] = {2, -1, -2};
    int b[3] = {7, 2, -3};

    int a_dot_b = dotProduct(a, b, 3);
    int a_dot_a = dotProduct(a, a, 3);

    int k = a_dot_b / a_dot_a;
```

```
int b1[3];
    scalarMultiply(a, k, b1, 3);

int b2[3];
    vectorSubtract(b, b1, b2, 3);

printf( Vector a: [%d, %d, %d]\n , a[0], a[1], a
    [2]);
printf( Vector b: [%d, %d, %d]\n , b[0], b[1], b
    [2]);
printf( Scalar k: %d\n , k);
printf( Vector b1 (parallel to a): [%d, %d, %d]\n
    , b1[0], b1[1], b1[2]);
printf( Vector b2 (perpendicular to a): [%d, %d, %
    d]\n , b2[0], b2[1], b2[2]);
}
```

```
1 import ctypes
2
3 # Load the shared object file
4 lib = ctypes.CDLL('./code.so')
5
6 # Call the solve_vectors function (no args, no return)
7 lib.solve_vectors()
```